

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 10

Prefix trans-



Today I am learning that the prefix **trans-** often means *across*, *through* or *from one place or state to another*.

1 Learn the Meaning

The prefix **trans-** often carries the idea of moving *across*, going *through*, or changing from one place or state to another.

transport = carry across **transplant** = move to a new place
transform = change form **transatlantic** = across the Atlantic

2 Build the Word

Add **trans-** to each base. Then explain the new word.

Base word	Prefix	New word	What it means
plant	trans-	_____	_____
form	trans-	_____	_____
Atlantic	trans-	_____	_____
national	trans-	_____	_____
continental	trans-	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

For a geography project, Mia investigated how people and goods move across long distances. She traced a **transatlantic** flight from Europe to North America and a **transcontinental** railway crossing a whole continent. She learned that **transport** can move people, food and materials from one place to another. In science, the class carefully **transplanted** seedlings from small pots into a garden bed. Over the next few weeks, the tiny plants began to **transform** as new leaves and stems appeared. Mia then **transferred** her measurements from a notebook to a chart and **transmitted** the results to a partner class. She noticed that many **trans-** words carry the idea of crossing, moving through, or changing from one place or state to another.



Highlight the **trans-** words. Decide whether each shows movement across or a change.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **trans-** word from the passage and investigate how the prefix shapes its meaning.

- Write a **trans-** word from the passage.

- What base word or word part can you see inside it?

- What does the whole word mean?

- How does **trans-** add the idea of *across*, *through* or *change*?

5 Sort the Meanings

Sort the **trans-** words by the idea they show.

transport transplant transfer transmit transatlantic
transform transformation

Movement across / through

Change in form or state

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- We had to _____ because _____.
- Use a **trans-** word in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the prefix **trans-**
- ☐ Explains the *across/through/change* idea
- ☐ Sorts **trans-** words by meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find a **trans-** word in a book or article. Record it and explain how the prefix helps with its meaning.